

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE  
2 BILL NO. 3076

By: Lepak of the House

and

Seifried of the Senate

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7 An Act relating to teachers; amending 70 O.S. 2021,  
8 Section 6-133, as amended by Section 1, Chapter 349,  
9 O.S.L. 2023 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-133),  
10 which relates to new and innovative pathways toward  
11 teacher certification; expanding definition of  
12 provider; clarifying definition of program; replacing  
13 State Board of Education with Commission for  
14 Educational Quality and Accountability; striking  
15 pilot program language; requiring the Commission to  
16 initiate a request for information from potential  
17 providers; providing a timeline for the approval or  
18 denial of applications; requiring the Commission to  
19 provide notice for a denial and an opportunity to  
20 remedy deficiencies; directing the Commission to  
21 develop, promote, and coordinate a public awareness  
22 program; requiring the Commission to promulgate  
23 rules; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as  
24 last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024  
(70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.3), which relates  
to alternative placement teaching certificates;  
adding alternative teacher preparation programs to  
eligibility requirements; providing an effective  
date; and declaring an emergency.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-133, as  
amended by Section 1, Chapter 349, O.S.L. 2023 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025,  
Section 6-133), is amended to read as follows:

1 Section 6-133. A. As used in this section:

2 1. "Provider" means an eligible school district, regional  
3 education service agency, institution of higher education, or other  
4 private or not-for-profit entity which is, or will be within three  
5 (3) years of being approved by the Commission for Educational  
6 Quality and Accountability, accredited by the Council for the  
7 Accreditation of Educator Preparation or the Association for  
8 Advancing Quality in Educator Preparation that seeks or has obtained  
9 approval of an alternative teacher preparation program consistent  
10 with this section; and

11 2. "Program" means an alternative teacher preparation program  
12 with content provided by a provider that leads toward teacher  
13 certification or licensure in a specific content area.

14 B. 1. ~~The State Board of Education~~ Commission for Educational  
15 Quality and Accountability shall ~~identify providers to~~ implement new  
16 and innovative pathways toward teacher certification ~~on a pilot~~  
17 ~~program basis~~ through alternative teacher preparation programs. The  
18 Commission shall initiate a request for information from potential  
19 providers and shall provide eligible providers with information  
20 concerning the application process. Providers seeking to  
21 ~~participate in the pilot program~~ shall submit applications to the  
22 ~~State Board of Education~~ Commission. The Commission shall approve  
23 or deny an application within sixty (60) days of submission. If the  
24 Commission denies an application, the Commission shall provide

1 notice with the reasons for the denial and permit the provider an  
2 opportunity to remedy the deficiencies.

3 2. The Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability  
4 shall develop, promote, and coordinate a public awareness program to  
5 be utilized in making potential teachers aware of approved providers  
6 and their programs. The State Board of Education shall post on its  
7 Internet website a list of approved providers, program requirements,  
8 and the cost of each program.

9 C. A provider ~~chosen~~ approved by the ~~State Board of Education~~  
10 ~~to participate in the pilot program~~ Commission for Educational  
11 Quality and Accountability shall offer a program that:

12 1. Provides evidence and history of fiscal solvency, capacity,  
13 operation, and program effectiveness;

14 2. Provides evidence of necessary infrastructure to provide  
15 accurate, timely, and secure data for the purpose of admission,  
16 teacher candidate monitoring, testing, and certification  
17 recommendations;

18 3. Has policies and procedures in place ensuring the security  
19 of teacher candidate records under applicable laws and regulations;

20 4. Has the instructional capacity within an existing novice  
21 teacher support program, the ability to obtain the instructional  
22 capacity, or has established a partnership with an accredited  
23 institution of higher education ~~institution~~ to provide adequate  
24 instruction in accordance with this subsection;

1        5. Offers an instructional phase that provides intensive  
2 preparation before the teacher candidates assume classroom  
3 responsibilities;

4        6. Offers a research-based and results-oriented approach  
5 focused on best teaching practices to increase student achievement  
6 and growth measured against state academic standards;

7        7. Provides assessment, supervision, and evaluation of teacher  
8 candidates to determine their specific needs throughout the program  
9 and to support efforts to successfully complete the program;

10       8. Provides intensive and ongoing professional development  
11 opportunities that accelerate a teacher candidate's professional  
12 growth, support student learning, and provide a workplace  
13 orientation, professional staff development, and mentoring;

14       9. Offers peer review focused on standards of professional  
15 practice and continuous professional growth; and

16       10. Provides a process to review a teacher candidate's final  
17 competency of required certification content standards that leads to  
18 a potential candidate being recommended for teacher certification in  
19 accordance with subsection F of this section.

20       D. ~~The State Board of Education~~ Commission for Educational  
21 Quality and Accountability shall ensure that providers ~~approved to~~  
22 ~~participate in the pilot program~~ allow teacher candidates to  
23 demonstrate pedagogy and content standard proficiency in school-  
24 based programs and through other nontraditional means.

1 Nontraditional means may include, but not be limited to, previous  
2 work experience, teacher experience, educator evaluations, industry-  
3 recognized certifications, and other essentially equivalent  
4 demonstrations.

5 E. If the ~~State Board of Education~~ Commission determines that a  
6 provider fails to meet or is deficient in any of the requirements of  
7 this section including failing to become accredited by the Council  
8 for the Accreditation of Educator Preparation or the Association for  
9 Advancing Quality in Educator Preparation within three (3) years of  
10 the date of approval by the Commission, ~~if~~ the Commission may  
11 suspend or revoke the approval of the provider after providing  
12 notification of the deficiencies and an opportunity to remedy the  
13 deficiencies within a specified period of time as determined by the  
14 Commission.

15 F. A teacher candidate that completes a program offered by an  
16 approved provider shall be eligible for certification, provided he  
17 or she meets the certification requirements set forth in Section 6-  
18 187 of this title in the area of specialization for which  
19 certification is sought and is recommended for certification by the  
20 approved provider.

21 G. The State Board of Education shall issue a certificate to  
22 teach to any person who meets the requirements set forth in this  
23 section and who has on file with the Board a current Oklahoma  
24 criminal history record check from the Oklahoma State Bureau of

Investigation as well as a national criminal history record check as defined in Section 150.9 of Title 74 of the Oklahoma Statutes. The person applying for the certificate shall be responsible for the cost of the criminal history record checks.

H. A provider shall submit a report to the ~~State Department of Education~~ Office of Educational Quality and Accountability after one (1) year of operation showing the percentage of teacher candidates who have completed the program and who have successfully completed or who have failed the competency examinations for certification and the provider's efforts to help candidates successfully pass the examinations. A provider shall annually submit a report to the ~~State Department of Education~~ Office of Educational Quality and Accountability outlining the success of the program.

I. The ~~State Board of Education may~~ Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability shall promulgate rules to implement the provisions of this section.

~~J. The pilot program created in this section shall end no later than July 1, 2026.~~

SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.3), is amended to read as follows:

Section 6-122.3. A. The State Board of Education shall grant an alternative placement teaching certificate to a person who makes application to the Board and meets the following criteria:

- 1        1.    a.    holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an  
2                    institution whose accreditation is recognized by the  
3                    Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has  
4                    attained a retention grade point average of not less  
5                    than 2.50 on a 4.0 scale, or  
6                    b.    has successfully completed a terminal degree, such as  
7                    a doctorate of philosophy, a doctorate in education,  
8                    professional doctorates, a master of fine arts degree  
9                    or a master of library science degree, from an  
10                   institution accredited by a national or regional  
11                   accrediting agency which is recognized by the  
12                   Secretary of the United States Department of  
13                   Education. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher  
14                   Education shall be consulted to verify other terminal  
15                   degrees, or  
16                   c.    holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an  
17                   institution whose accreditation is recognized by the  
18                   Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has  
19                   qualified work experience in a field that corresponds  
20                   to an area of certification as determined by the State  
21                   Board of Education, and  
22                   d.    in addition to the requirements of subparagraphs a, b  
23                   and c of this paragraph, has demonstrated competency  
24                   or completed a major in a field that corresponds to an

1 area of specialization for an Elementary-Secondary  
2 Certificate or a Secondary Certificate as determined  
3 by the State Board of Education or a vocational-  
4 technical certificate as recommended by the Oklahoma  
5 Department of Career and Technology Education;

6 2. Declares the intention to earn standard certification by  
7 means of an alternative placement program or an alternative teacher  
8 preparation program provided for in Section 6-133 of this title in  
9 not more than three (3) years. The State Board of Education shall  
10 determine the subject matter and the number of clock or semester  
11 hours required for the professional education component for each  
12 person making application for an alternative placement teaching  
13 certificate based on the criteria of paragraph 1 of this subsection.

14 The State Board of Education shall establish a core minimum of  
15 six (6) semester hours or ninety (90) clock hours and a maximum of  
16 eighteen (18) semester hours or two hundred seventy (270) clock  
17 hours for the professional education component.

18 The requirements set forth in this subsection shall exclude all  
19 student teaching requirements pursuant to the provisions of  
20 subsection E of this section;

21 3. Has passed the subject area portion of the competency  
22 examination required in Section 6-187 of this title in the area of  
23 specialization for which certification is sought; and  
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1        4. Either presents a document from an accredited public school  
2 district in this state offering employment in the area of  
3 specialization for which certification is sought on condition that  
4 the person enroll in an alternative placement program approved by  
5 the State Board of Education or declares the intention to seek  
6 employment as a teacher at an accredited public school district in  
7 this state. The certificate granted pursuant to this subsection  
8 shall be considered a "valid certificate of qualification" for the  
9 purposes of Sections 6-107 and 6-108 of this title, and the holder  
10 of the certificate shall be considered an inductee for the purposes  
11 of Section 6-195 of this title.

12        B. An alternative placement teaching certificate shall be  
13 renewed for not more than a maximum of three (3) years upon  
14 presentation of a document from an accredited public school district  
15 in this state offering renewed employment in the same area of  
16 specialization and a document from a teacher education institution  
17 verifying satisfactory progress in an appropriate alternative  
18 placement program.

19        C. Persons enrolled in an alternative placement program shall:

20        1. Have never been denied admittance to a teacher education  
21 program approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education,  
22 the North Central Association of Colleges and Schools and by the  
23 Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation to offer teacher  
24 education programs, nor have enrolled in and subsequently failed

1 courses necessary to successfully meet the minimum requirements of  
2 the program, except those persons who hold a certificate;

3 2. Have on file with the director of teacher education at an  
4 Oklahoma institution of higher education a plan for meeting standard  
5 certification requirements within three (3) years; and

6 3. Participate in an induction program as required in Section  
7 6-195 of this title and have the same duties and responsibilities as  
8 other inductees.

9 D. The State Board of Education may grant an exception to the  
10 requirements for certification and, upon demonstration by an  
11 individual of specific competency in the subject area of  
12 specialization, may grant a certificate to the individual. The  
13 State Board may establish other requirements necessary to grant  
14 exceptions.

15 E. The State Board of Education, in consultation with the  
16 Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, may grant an  
17 exception to the requirement to complete a subject area examination  
18 for initial certification in a field which does not require an  
19 advanced degree pursuant to this section if the candidate has an  
20 advanced degree in a subject that is substantially comparable to the  
21 content assessed on a subject area examination. The degree shall be  
22 from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting  
23 agency which is recognized by the Secretary of the U.S. Department  
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1 of Education. The Commission shall provide the Board with the  
2 necessary information to determine comparability.

3 F. Student teaching and a prestudent teaching field experience  
4 shall not be required of alternative placement program participants  
5 for standard certification.

6 G. The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules  
7 authorizing adjunct teachers who shall be persons with distinguished  
8 qualifications in their field. Adjunct teachers shall not be  
9 required to meet standard certification. A person employed as an  
10 adjunct teacher pursuant to this subsection who does not hold a  
11 valid certificate to teach shall not be considered a teacher as  
12 defined by Section 1-116 of this title.

13 H. Each teacher education institution shall provide the  
14 Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation an annual report of  
15 information as specified by the Commission regarding participation  
16 in the alternative placement programs offered by the institution.

17 I. The Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation shall not  
18 accredit, renew the accreditation of, or otherwise approve any  
19 teacher education program of any institution of higher education in  
20 this state that has not implemented alternative placement programs  
21 in at least four areas of specialization including mathematics,  
22 science and a foreign language. Each institution shall allow  
23 individuals who meet the criteria of subsections A and C of this  
24 section to be:

1        1. Admitted to an alternative placement program without further  
2 qualification; and

3        2. Offered the opportunity to complete the requirements for  
4 standard certification set forth in subsection A of this section  
5 during the summer preceding and the summer following the first year  
6 of teaching with an alternative placement teaching certificate. Any  
7 person seeking standard certification through an alternative  
8 placement program shall be permitted to take necessary courses  
9 during regular semesters if offered.

10       J. The criteria specified in subsection I of this section can  
11 be met through a cooperative arrangement entered into by two or more  
12 institutions of higher education.

13       SECTION 3. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

14       SECTION 4. It being immediately necessary for the preservation  
15 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby  
16 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and  
17 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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1 Passed the House of Representatives the 11th day of March, 2026.

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3 \_\_\_\_\_  
4 Presiding Officer of the House  
5 of Representatives

6 Passed the Senate the \_\_\_\_\_ day of \_\_\_\_\_, 2026.

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8 \_\_\_\_\_  
9 Presiding Officer of the Senate